

Butterflies & Moths

Did you spot them all this year? Surprising results from the Big Butterfly Count



Comma 40% ↓



Small Tortoiseshell Worst yet! *Peacock* 9% ↑



Brimstone 20% ↓



Six-spot Burnet Moth 59% ↓



Ringlet 62% ↓



Gatekeeper 54% ↓



Meadow Brown 56% ↓



Whites Lg&Sm 100% ↑



Orange Tip



Speckled Wood 12% ↑



Common Blue 51% ↑



Small Blue



Painted Lady 4% ↓



Red Admiral 73% ↓

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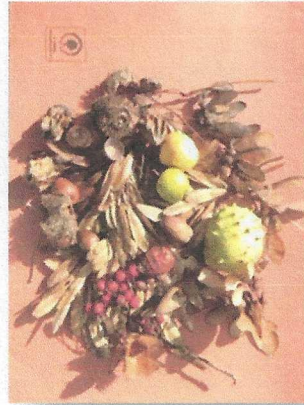
Our warm and sunny summer provided disappointing numbers as The Big Butterfly Count Report says:

- Warm weather from April onwards meant flight periods were earlier this year so maybe Meadow Browns and Ringlets were past their prime by August
- Stand-out winners were the Whites, large and small. Ask the gardeners!!
- Common Blue highest since 2010, numbers increasing 51% every year since 2010
- Of the migrants, Red Admiral decreased substantially while the Painted Lady remained the same
- Worst discovery of all was the Small Tortoiseshell. Numbers have slumped. They're at $\frac{3}{4}$ of UK population since the 70s. This year was worst on record and worryingly no clear reason why
- One species, the Red Admiral which did very well in 2017 was one of the biggest losers this year. The cold spells in early spring may have killed over-wintering Red Admirals and their offspring and, in addition, there were low numbers migrating to the UK during spring and early summer

See list below for the 19 species targeted this year – figures % change from 2017

Small White	161%	Small Tortoiseshell	-32%
Large White	104%	Comma	-40%
Gatekeeper	-54%	Holly Blue	122%
Peacock	9%	Painted Lady	-4%
Meadow Brown	-56%	Ringlet	-62%
Common Blue	51%	Small Copper	4%
Green-veined White	78%	Brimstone	-20%
Speckled Wood	12%	Six-spot Burnet	-59%
Red Admiral	-73%	Marbled White	-70%

And Other Things



To Autumn

Season of mists and mellow fruitfulness,
Close bosom-friend of the maturing sun;
Conspiring with him how to load and bless
With fruit the vines that round the thatch-eaves
run;

To bend with apples the moss'd cottage-trees,
And fill all fruit with ripeness to the core;
To swell the gourd, and plump the hazel shells . .

John Keats 1819